

Government may impose duty on electronic goods

A government committee is contemplating to impose basic customs duty on selected electronic hardware goods. These electronic items are not there in the obligatory zero customs duty list under World Trade Organisation's information technology pact signed in the year 1996. The panel, which is headed by J. Satyanarayana, secretary, DeitY, is planning to modify the inverted duty structure in the electronic hardware sector.

The committee members also includes Commerce Ministry officials. The government is planning to take this step with a view to promote domestic manufacturing of electronic hardware. Local manufacturing is facing problems due to the inverted duty structure.

₹ 300 bn investment proposals for electronic and IT sector

In the last six months, the Union government has received investment proposals to the tune of ₹ 300 billion for the electronics and IT industry apart from 15 proposals for establishing electronics clusters.

"The government has already received 15 proposals to set up electronics clusters, out of which six have been approved and some of these have already started setting up these clusters," Business Standard quoted Ajay Kumar, joint secretary, DeitY. "In last six months, the government has received investment proposals for around ₹ 30,000 crore for the industry," he added.

According to the new Electronics Policy, 2013, the government would incur 50 per cent of the cost of the project with a ceiling of ₹ 500 million for each 100 acres of land so that this incentive by the government will boost the establishment of electronics manufacturing clusters.

Freescal appoints Satinder Sohi as India director

Freescal Semiconductor Inc. has appointed Satinder Sohi as the director for its operations in India. The role of Sohi will involve leading Freescal's R&D centres in NOIDA, Bengaluru and Hyderabad.

Genius appoints Gaurav Mathur as country business head

Genius India announced the appointment of Gaurav Mathur as the country business head. Mathur would be responsible for driving the company's growth, through greater market penetration and strengthening the brand equity.

In Focus

Awards

Vishay India declares Distributor Awards

Recognising the contribution of its outstanding distributors, Vishay Intertechnology India declared the Distributor Awards for 2012. The winners of this year's Awards included Elektronika Sales Pvt Ltd, WPG Electronics, Arrow Electronics, Inc., and Future Electronics.

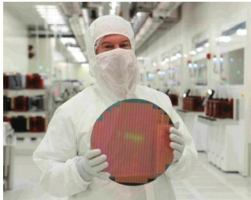
The government of India has already approved three projects to the tune of ₹ 2 billion under the electronic manufacturing clusters (EMC) scheme. The proposals were received from ELCINA and MPSEDC.

Two semiconductor fabs get Cabinet's initial nod

The Union Cabinet has given an initial approval to set up two semiconductor wafer fabrication (fab) manufacturing facilities in the country. However, the Cabinet would now seek proposals from more chip manufacturers before giving the final nod. The Cabinet took

the decision after reviewing proposals from two consortia and the final decision will be taken soon. According to reports, government has already received two proposals worth ₹ 263 billion and ₹ 252 billion to set up semiconductor facilities at Noida in Uttar Pradesh and Prantij in Gujarat, respectively.

"The Cabinet has given in-principle approval for setting up of semiconductor wafer fabrication manufacturing facilities," Information and Broadcasting minister Manish Tewari told reporters after a meeting of the Cabinet, chaired by PM Manmohan Singh.



Semiconductor fabrication plant

World PCB market grew 1.7 per cent in 2012

The world market for PCBs reached nearly \$60 billion in 2012, with 1.7 per cent real growth over 2011, according to IPC's World PCB Production Report. Asia is the largest producer of PCBs with 90 per cent share of world's PCB production. China is the No. 1 producer of PCBs with 42.8 per cent share, Japan is a distant second with 16 per cent.